THE MASTERMIND COACHING CLASSES

CBSE / RBSE • NURSERY – CLASS XII • JAIPUR

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CLASS 8 — SOCIAL SCIENCE · HARD LEVEL UNIT TEST SET 3

Chapters 2–4: **Reshaping India's Political Map, The Rise of the Marathas, The Colonial Era in India** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 2 Hours Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 50**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–15 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 16–20 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 21–25 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 26–27 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 24–25 and Q. 26–27.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 15 × 1 = 15

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. A student says 'Medieval' means the Middle Ages everywhere. A better reply is 1

(a) The term is borrowed and here denotes the 11th-17th centuries in India
(b) Correct
(c) It means ancient
(d) It means after 1857

2. Because forts were located on hills, the Mughal cavalry 1

(a) struggled to use its strength **(b)** needed no horses
(c) easily won **(d)** rode inside

3. Which was a long-term consequence of Plassey? 1

(a) Dutch rule
(b) Company moved from trade to political control
(c) French control
(d) Mughal revival

4. Why is a hundi like a modern cheque? 1

(a) It is land **(b)** It authorises payment to a named person
(c) It is coin **(d)** It is a tax

5. The expression 'Hindavi Swarajya' implies 1

(a) empire of Persians **(b)** theocracy
(c) foreign colony **(d)** a kingdom of the people of the land

6. In a famine, free kitchens and tax waivers would show 1

(a) exploitation **(b)** relief policy **(c)** profit **(d)** neglect

7. If a ruler with fewer men wins by guns against elephants and cavalry, the key factor is 1

(a) luck only **(b)** technology **(c)** religion **(d)** numbers

8. A ruler uses a Sanskrit seal and local language instead of Persian. This shows 1

(a) cultural assertion **(b)** trade
(c) foreign rule **(d)** no interest

9. The statement 'Railways were laid with Indian money but served British aims' suggests 1

(a) benefit to farmers **(b)** no effect
(c) exploitation **(d)** free gift

10. A document says merchants sent money by hundi to distant towns without moving coin. It implies 1

(a) no towns
(b) a trusted network of agents
(c) no trade
(d) state ban on trade

11. The Treaty of Purandar can be seen as 1

(a) end of Marathas
(b) victory
(c) a tactical retreat
(d) complete defeat

12. Rani Abbakka's use of fireballs shows 1

(a) creative defence against a stronger fleet
(b) trade
(c) use of cannon only
(d) fear

13. **Assertion (A):** The Battle of Saraighat (1671) was won by the Ahoms under Lachit Borphukan. 1
Reason (R): The Ahoms were defeated by the Mughals at Saraighat on the Brahmaputra.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

14. **Assertion (A):** The Third Battle of Panipat (1761) was fought between the Marathas and Ahmad Shah Abdali. 1
Reason (R): The Marathas won a decisive victory at Panipat.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

15. **Assertion (A):** The Doctrine of Lapse was introduced by Lord Wellesley. 1
Reason (R): Under the Doctrine of Lapse a state could be annexed if its ruler died without a natural male heir.
Choose the correct option:
(a) Both A and R are true and R is the correct explanation of A.
(b) Both A and R are true but R is not the correct explanation of A.
(c) A is true but R is false.
(d) A is false but R is true.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) 5 × 2 = 10

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

16. A fort is built on a hill with sea on one side. What advantages does it give? 2

17. Why is the Doctrine of Lapse called unfair? 2

18. Why did Lachit Borphukan's victory matter to Assam? 2

19. How did chauth increase Maratha influence? 2

20. How did the Resident control a ruler? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) 5 × 3 = 15

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

21. Assess the importance of Colachel in global history. 3

22. A merchant uses hundis. Explain two advantages and a risk. 3

23. Why might historians disagree about chauth? 3

24. Examine how the British used religion and caste to divide Indians after 1857. 3

OR

Case: A weaker army wins by using hills and forests. Name two such cases and the leaders. 3

25. Evaluate the Maratha guerrilla tactics against a larger Mughal army. 3

OR

Source: 'Indian in blood but English in taste.' Identify the author and the aim. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

26. **Case study.** In 1770 Bengal suffered a terrible famine, yet the Company continued to demand heavy land revenue. About one-third of Bengal's population is said to have died. During another Great Famine of 1876-78, under Viceroy Lord Lytton, grain was still being exported from India. 5

(i) What share of Bengal's population died in 1770?

(ii) Who was the Viceroy during 1876-78?

(iii) Name the author of 'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'.

(iv) How did colonial policies make famines worse?

27. How do sources such as the Adnyapatra and Modi records help us understand Maratha rule? 5

OR

Case study: A district sees railway lines built to the port while local markets decline. Analyse the colonial economy. 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER Total: 50 Marks

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